

RICA Multi-Agent Feature — Release Plan

Feature: Multi-Agent Orchestration System (v4.0)

Target Release Date: May 20, 2026

Branch: multiagent-test | **Current Tag:** v1.1.4

Release Version: v2.0.0

Overview

The multi-agent orchestration system enables RICA to decompose complex tasks and delegate them across multiple AI agents working in parallel or sequentially. This plan outlines a phased rollout from internal testing through to production release, ensuring stability and quality at each stage.

Key Capabilities Being Released

- **Workflow Patterns** — Single agent, parallel execution, sequential execution, and orchestrator (auto) modes
- **Agent Management** — Task decomposition, sub-agent spawning, context bridging, and fault handling
- **UI Components** — Multi-agent panel, agent tree view, batch operations display, and workflow pattern selector
- **Token Tracking** — Real API usage capture with tiktoken fallback estimation

Build Artifacts

Platform	VSIX Package
Linux x64	rica-linux-x64.vsix
Windows x64	rica-win32-x64.vsix
macOS x64	rica-darwin-x64.vsix
macOS ARM64	rica-darwin-arm64.vsix

Phase 1 — Internal Testing (Apr 21–25)

Build: v1.1.4

Objectives

- Validate all workflow patterns function correctly end-to-end
- Identify bugs, edge cases, and UX issues early
- Confirm cross-platform compatibility on Windows and Linux

Scope

- Distribute VSIX (v1.1.4) to internal team
- Test all four modes: single agent, parallel, sequential, and orchestrator (auto)
- Validate on both Windows and Linux environments
- Log all bugs and edge cases in shared tracker
- Clean up debug logging statements from codebase
- Verify token tracking accuracy (real API counts vs tiktoken estimates)

Test Scenarios

- **Simple task** — Fix a single bug in one file using single agent mode
- **Multi-file task** — Refactor a feature across 3+ files using parallel agents
- **Dependent task** — Sequential agents where Agent B depends on Agent A's output
- **Failure recovery** — Cancel a running agent mid-task, verify cleanup
- **Large codebase** — Run orchestrator on a task spanning 10+ files

Exit Criteria

- All 4 workflow patterns work end-to-end on both Windows and Linux
 - No blocking or critical bugs remaining
 - Token counts reported accurately
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Phase 2 — Bug Fixes & Beta Build (Apr 27–28)

Build: v2.0.0-beta

Objectives

- Address all critical and high-priority bugs found during internal testing
- Produce a stable beta build for pilot users
- Prepare onboarding materials for wider team

Scope

- Triage and prioritize bugs from Phase 1

- Fix all critical, blocking, and high-priority UX issues
- Cut v2.0.0-beta build via CI/CD pipeline
- Verify beta build installs and runs correctly on all platforms
- Identify 5–10 pilot users from the wider team
- Prepare quick-start guide for pilot users

Exit Criteria

- v2.0.0-beta VSIX packages built and verified on all platforms
 - All critical bugs resolved
 - Pilot user list and onboarding materials ready
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Holiday Break — Apr 29 to May 6 (Golden Week)

No active development. Team returns May 7.

Phase 3 — Pilot Release (May 7–9)

Build: v2.0.0-beta

Objectives

- Gather real-world feedback from users outside the immediate team
- Validate that the feature is intuitive without hand-holding
- Identify issues that internal testing missed

Scope

- Distribute v2.0.0-beta VSIX to 5–10 pilot users
- Brief pilot users on multi-agent capabilities and how to get started
- Collect structured feedback on UX, performance, and reliability
- Monitor for unexpected failures or confusing behavior
- Review and update documentation based on pilot experience
- Fix issues found during pilot testing

Feedback Areas

- **Discoverability** — Can users find and activate multi-agent mode easily?

- **Clarity** — Is the agent tree view understandable? Are status indicators clear?
- **Performance** — Are response times acceptable? Any noticeable lag?
- **Error Handling** — Do failures surface clearly? Can users recover gracefully?
- **Documentation** — Are the guides sufficient to get started independently?

Exit Criteria

- Pilot users can use multi-agent mode independently
 - No new critical bugs discovered
 - Feedback collected and triaged for Phase 4
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Phase 4 — Stabilization & Pre-Production (May 12–16)

Build: v2.0.0-rc1

Objectives

- Finalize all fixes from pilot feedback
- Merge feature branch into main
- Comprehensive regression and stress testing
- Produce release candidate

Scope

- Final round of fixes addressing pilot feedback
- Merge `multiagent-test` branch into `main`
- Full regression test on main branch build
- Stress testing across all workflow patterns
- Verify all 4 platform builds pass CI/CD
- Cut release candidate v2.0.0-rc1
- Prepare release notes and changelog

Stress Test Scenarios

- Spawn 5+ parallel agents editing different files simultaneously
- Run orchestrator on a task requiring 10+ subtasks
- Trigger agent failures mid-execution and verify recovery
- Run multiple concurrent multi-agent sessions
- Test with large files (1000+ lines) and large codebases

Exit Criteria

- Release candidate stable for 2+ days with no new bugs
 - All platform builds passing CI/CD
 - Release notes and changelog complete
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Phase 5 — Production Release (May 19–20)

Build: v2.0.0

May 19 — Final Preparation

- Final smoke test of v2.0.0-rc1 across all platforms
- Tag final v2.0.0 in repository
- Build production VSIX packages via CI/CD (all 4 platforms)
- Verify all VSIX packages install and run correctly

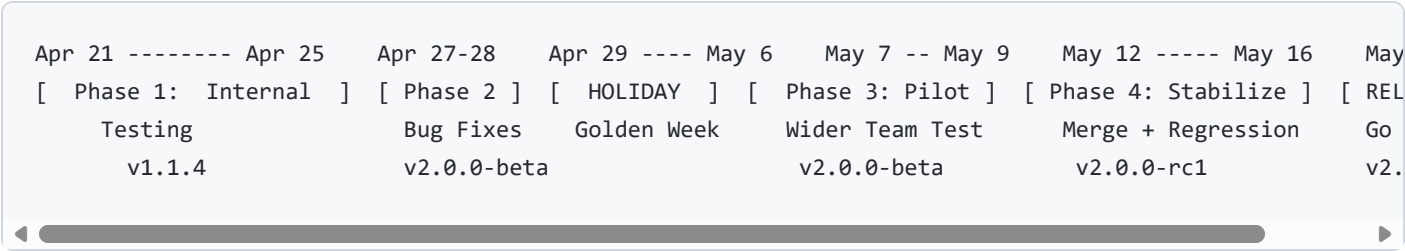
May 20 — Release Day

- Publish VSIX packages to internal distribution channel
 - Send release announcement to full team with release notes
 - Monitor for Day 1 issues
 - Hotfix and re-release if critical issues arise
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Risk Management

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Holiday shortens Phase 2 to 2 days	Medium	Certain	Front-load bug fixes in Phase 1; use Apr 27–28 for build prep only
Pilot users find major UX issues	High	Medium	Phase 3 buffer + Phase 4 dedicated to fixes
Merge conflicts when merging to main	Medium	Low	Keep main stable; rebase before merge
Platform-specific bugs (Windows vs Linux)	High	Medium	Test both platforms in Phase 1; CI builds all 4 targets
Token tracking inaccuracies	Low	Medium	Verify in Phase 1; tiktoken fallback estimation is safe
Performance degradation with many agents	Medium	Low	Stress testing in Phase 4 covers this

Timeline Summary



Document prepared: April 20, 2026
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